

Unit 8 Religion and Society Based on a Study of Christianity and at Least One Other Religion

Content overview

This unit requires students to study the relationship between religion and society, especially in the UK. There are four sections covering rights and responsibilities, environmental and medical issues, peace and conflict, and crime and punishment.

Students are required to base their studies on Christianity and at least ONE, but no more than TWO, of the following religions: Buddhism, Hinduism, Islam, Judaism, Sikhism. However, Section 1 is based on a study of Christianity only. Through this study of current social and community issues based on the study of two religions, students should be encouraged to relate their studies to the issues of social and community cohesion.

Key words are given at the beginning of each section. Students should be aware of their meanings and be able to use them in their examination answers. A glossary of the key words can be found in *Appendix 4*.

In order to meet Assessment Objective 2, students need to be aware of a range of responses addressing religious and/or non-religious beliefs.

Assessment overview

Assessment will be through a one-and-a-half-hour examination. The examination will be divided into four sections and students will be expected to choose one of the two questions set on each section, ie four questions in total. Each question is sub-divided into four parts structured on an incline of difficulty.

Religious Studies papers are designed to give access to the full range of grades and are not tiered.

Quality of Written Communication will be assessed through Assessment Objective 1 in part c) of each question.

Detailed unit content

Section 8.1 Religion: rights and responsibilities

This section is based on a study of Christianity only.

Students will be required to: demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the specification; express their own responses to the issues and questions raised by the specification using reasons and evidence; evaluate alternative points of view about these issues and questions.

Key words — Bible, Church, conscience, the Decalogue, democratic processes, electoral processes, Golden Rule, human rights, political party, pressure group, Situation Ethics, social change

- Why some Christians use only the Bible as a basis for making moral decisions.
- The authority of the Church for Christians and why some Christians use only the Church's teachings as a basis for making moral decisions.
- The role of conscience and why some Christians believe conscience is the most important guide in making moral decisions.
- Situation Ethics and why some Christians use only Situation Ethics as a guide for making moral decisions.
- Why some Christians use a variety of authorities in making moral decisions.
- Human rights in the UK.
- Why human rights are important for Christians.
- Why it is important to take part in democratic and electoral processes.
- Christian teachings on moral duties and responsibilities: the Golden Rule (Matthew 7:12), the Parable of the Sheep and the Goats (Matthew 25:31-46), Am I my brother's keeper? (Genesis 4:1-10, 1 John 3:11-18).
- The nature of genetic engineering, including cloning.
- Different attitudes to genetic engineering and cloning in Christianity and the reasons for them.